
Step Forward on Sponsorships

Building New Revenue Through
Mission-Aligned Partnerships

Presented by:

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Emily Dresslar

June 2026

Introductions and Full Agenda

3-Part Work Session Agenda

01 **The Partnership Approach:** Shift to a Partnership Mindset

02 **Identifying the Right Partners:** Prospecting & Warm Leads

03 **Building the Sponsorship:** Workflow & Scenarios

We will close each session sharing out on our exercises and discussing ideas

Session 1: The Partnership Approach

Session 1: Agenda

- Focus on Sponsorships
-
- Getting Started: Consultative Selling
-
- Comprehensive & Creative offerings + Open discussion
-

Navigating the revenue landscape

Advertising / Platform Revenue

Transactional +
dependent on scale.
Subject to change.

Subscriptions / Memberships

Direct audience
support. Loyalty and
constant care.

Philanthropic Support

Grants, foundations
and underwriting.
Programming-based.

Sponsorships

Direct partner support.
High potential to
builds long-term
relationships. Plus
compliments content.

Our focus: Comprehensive, mission-aligned, sponsorships

Core concept: Comprehensive campaigns that benefit the creator, the sponsor, and the audience.

Key Characteristics

Mission Alignment

Partnering with organizations that share your core values and audience interests.

High Value, Low Volume

Securing fewer, larger partnerships rather than managing dozens of small, low-value ads.

Integration

Sponsor messaging that compliments your content

Sales Philosophy

What is Consultative Selling?

It's solving problems, not just pitching products.

We'll practice the 4 Key questions for your script in later sessions

✓ **Ask, Don't Tell:**

Focus on goals and challenges.

✓ **Active Listening:**

Uncover the "why"

✓ **Tailored Solutions:**

Custom packages for specific needs.

✓ **Value Over Price:**

Focus on our unique audience.

Align what you deliver with what partners actually need



The Value Proposition =

What We Can Deliver

- Engaged, niche audiences
- Brand safety
- Multiple platforms
- You!

What Partners Need

- Brand Awareness
- New Leads
- Thought Leadership
- Content

Your value proposition is the bridge: how your specific assets fulfill their specific business goals.

Getting Started



Prioritize a positioning statement for flexibility

Don't let sales materials get in the way of getting started!

The Media Kit

- Often static, dense with metrics, and focused on pricing and focused on US.
- Useful as a follow-up document, but rarely closes a deal on its own.
- Offer just a taste to start a conversation!

The Positioning Statement

- A concise, 1-2 page document
- Focuses on audience profile, mission, and specific value for partners. Focused on Them.
- Adaptable to different prospects.

Leveraging All



Core Strategy: A comprehensive sponsorship leverages all audience touchpoints to create a campaign with multiple entry points. Examples of ways brands can connect:

- **General Visibility**
 - Logo & ad placements on digital assets or at events
 - "Sponsored By" mentions
- **Direct Engagement**
 - Dedicated audio or video messages
 - Sponsored content articles or messages within newsletters
- **Creative Integration**
 - Custom editorial series underwritten by the brand
 - Hosting webinars or in-person events together
 - What else? Get Creative!

Examples & Review



The Texas Tribune Festival

Presented by
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November 13-15

10:02
TeamReach

texastribune.org

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Constitutional Amendments

Brian Harris

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The Texas Tribune Festival

★ **MARYLAND GOV. WES MOORE**
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12:08



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3 NEW FEATURED SPEAKERS



Nov. 13-15

Downtown Austin

Deb Haaland, Joan Harwood and Jake Tapper join this year's TribFest lineup

BY **MATT EWALT** SEPT. 10, 2025

The history-making former interior secretary, Houston's longtime state senator and CNN's lead DC anchor join us in

The Texas Tribune Festival

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THE FUTURE OF TEXAS TODAY

NOV. 13-15 | DOWNTOWN AUSTIN

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It's where Texas' biggest leaders, builders and innovators bring the ideas and actions transforming our state. One into infinite possibilities and hope inspired to make your business ideas reality.

As a Texas Tribune member, you get discounted tickets and exclusive TribFest perks. Use your member discount code (TT25MEMBER) at checkout to unlock your discount. There's also an extra \$80 when the printed save even less! TT25MEMBER and TT25MEMBERSHOPCARD is checked to stack your savings!

GET DISCOUNTED TICKETS AT TRIBFEST.ORG



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Make Growth Happen



Ashley Brooks
General Manager, La Loma Kiosk Cafe

With more than 155 years of serving this state, we know that Texas means business. We've backed 76,000 small businesses with tools, resources and capital because we believe in entrepreneurship fuels the economy — and growing the economy is our business.

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Dear Texas

We're so proud to serve you.

Recently, in my annual letter to shareholders around the globe, I reflected on why Texas is an economic powerhouse and so important to our bank's success.

The answer is simple: Texas values free enterprise and is open for business. It's our role to help clients, customers, communities and employees — from Dallas to Austin to El Paso — grow our economy.

Building on 150+ years of doing business in Texas, JPMorganChase continues to:

- Finance businesses of all sizes. We provide billions of dollars in credit and capital to hundreds of thousands of small, mid-size and large companies in industries such as oil and gas, technology, metals and nonprofit organizations.
- Help vital institutions serve local communities. We serve over 400 government, education, health care and nonprofit organizations.
- Create well-paying jobs and career pathways. JPMorganChase has more employees in Texas than any other bank in the country.
- Expand access to banking. We have over 450 branches across Texas. In 2024 alone, we provided more than 22,000 hours of advice and support — including to small businesses.
- Fortify local financial institutions. We back more than 80 regional, mid-sized and community banks in Texas, which play an essential role in helping new local businesses.

Thank you for being a home to our employees, business and future growth. I encourage you to read my full letter to learn more about how we power economic growth and create opportunities across Texas, the United States and the world.



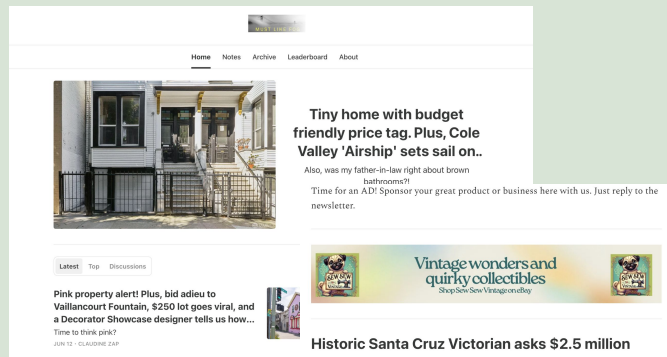
Jamie Dixon
Chairman and CEO, JPMorganChase

31,500	8.5M
Local employees	Texas customers
783,000	\$100M
Small business clients	In partnership, capital between 2019 and 2024

JPMorganChase
jpmorganchase.com/celebrates

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Creative Examples & Review



Home Notes Archive Leaderboard About

Tiny home with budget friendly price tag. Plus, Cole Valley 'Airship' sets sail on..

Also, was my father-in-law right about brown bathrooms?!

Time for an AD? Sponsor your great product or business here with us. Just reply to the newsletter.

Latest Top Discussions

Pink property alert! Plus, bid adieu to Vaillancourt Fountain, \$250 lot goes viral, and a Decorator Showcase designer tells us how... Time to think pink?

JUN 12 - CLAUDINE ZAP

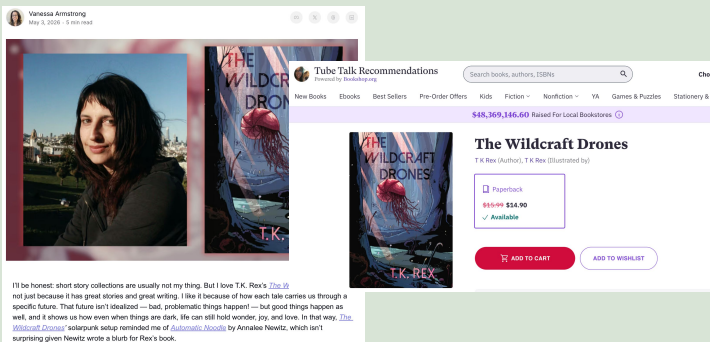


Historic Santa Cruz Victorian asks \$2.5 million

When I picture Victorians, it's within the foggy milieu of my hometown. But a new listing in Santa Cruz is a reminder these ornate homes flourish outside of the San Francisco city limits.

This historic and sprawling six-bedroom abode on the city's historic Mission Plaza was built over back in 1907. It's associated with *Commerce* owner Sam Dick Robinson and

City Guides offers 70 walking tours of SF. They range from a stroll through the Japanese Tea Garden, a look at the Ferry Building, exploring the Presidio, or a glance back at 1850s San Francisco. And best of all, they're all free.



Vanessa Armstrong
May 3, 2024 · 5 min read

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\$48,369,146.60 Raised For Local Bookstores

The Wildcraft Drones
T.K. Rex (Author), T.K. Rex (Illustrated by)

Paperback
\$19.99
✓ Available

ADD TO CART ADD TO WISHLIST

I'll be honest: short story collections are usually not my thing. But I love T.K. Rex's [Drones](#) not just because it has great stories and great writing. I like it because of how each tale carries us through a specific future. That future isn't idealized — bad, problematic things happen! — but good things happen as well, and it shows us how even when things are dark, life can still hold wonder, joy, and love. In that way, [The Wildcraft Drones](#) intersperses settings rendered me of [Autumn Roads](#) by Annalee Newitz, which isn't surprising given Newitz wrote a blurb for Rex's book.

Commentary: An Experiment

For the summer, Board Rule is inviting brief commentary on issues before the Chicago Board of Education, as well as broader issues facing the Chicago Public Schools. Here are our submission guidelines:

Keep it brief: 400 words, plus suggested headline and author bio.

Keep it relevant: Topics should be focused on Chicago's school board and school district.

Ground opinion in facts: Board Rule appreciates links to evidence for your op

Parent and community voices first: Board Rule will prioritize commentary from those closest to the schools and neighborhoods farthest from opportunity.

Please submit commentary, ideally as a Google Doc, to maureen.boardrule@gmail.com. If you have not received a response within a week, that means Board Rule will be unable to publish your commentary. Board Rule will not publish commentary during the height of campaign season, between August 15 and November 15.

With that, here's our inaugural op-ed, from Hibbard Elementary parent Maggie Cullerton Hooper.



Haugan Elementary cheerleaders. (Photo courtesy Haugan Elementary website.)

Immigration enforcement is not a solution to overcrowding

Last fall, I sat in my local ward office sorting Halloween candy bags for the 800-plus Albany Park children using walking school bus programs. We wanted every student to celebrate the holiday with some sense of normalcy amid the months-long campaign of state-sanctioned terror.

Suddenly, the sharp shrill of whistles sent everyone racing outside. Our alderwoman, her staff, and ordinary neighbors were immediately faced with yet another ICE confrontation — pepper balls shot at us, chemical weapons deployed, all while being physically and verbally assaulted. In the end, two young men were ripped away from our community.

Open Discussion: Exercise #1

Exercise: Conduct a simple audit of your brand's current output. List all platforms where you reach your audience (Examples: YouTube, newsletters, Instagram, speaking engagements, etc.). For each platform, provide a few bullet points detailing your audience size and growth, what you know about their demographics or interests, and what content is currently resonating most.

NOTE: The audit exercise can help forms the inventory for our positioning and proposals

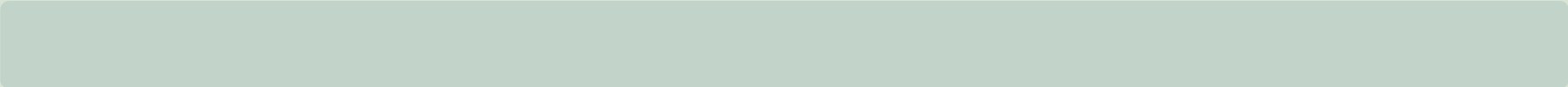
Next Exercise: Inspiration Audit

 **Audit 3 content creators or news outlets you admire:**

 *Identify their sponsor approach on various platforms, the types of messaging that runs alongside their content, and the types of organizations that sponsor their work. What stands out?*

 *What job is the sponsor solving for?*

 *What are some similar organizations for your brand?*



Next Session: Identifying Partners

Get into the prospecting work — how to find mission-aligned sponsors, approach them without feeling like a salesperson, and leverage your existing assets.
